

Πλάτων, Λύσις

Lysis the Athenian in Plato's Dialogues

eul_aid: dno

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Φιλοσοφική Ἀττική](#) [Attic](#) [Philosophical](#)
Domain: [Φιλοσοφία](#) [Philosophy](#)
Format: [Ἐπιστολή](#) [Epistle](#)
Affiliation: [Platonist](#)

Lysis is a figure from Classical Athens in the late 5th century BCE, known exclusively as a character in a philosophical dialogue by Plato. He is presented as a young Athenian boy, the son of Democrates, and a friend of another youth named Menexenus.

The dialogue named after him, Lysis, is set around 409 BCE and features Lysis and his friend in conversation with Socrates. Lysis is not historically attested as an author or philosopher. His entire significance lies within Plato's work, where he serves as an interlocutor. The dialogue uses his character to explore the nature of friendship, or *philia*, examining whether it is based on similarity, opposition, or the pursuit of the good.

According to modern scholars, the Lysis is an important early Platonic text for the study of ethics and personal relationships. No writings are attributed to a historical person named Lysis. The sources confirm he is a literary character created by Plato for philosophical discussion, with no evidence of independent works or a separate philosophical tradition.

Works (2)

- [Ἐπιστολή πρὸς Ἱππάρχον](#) · [Letter to Hipparchus](#) · 4 passages
- [Μαρτυρίαι](#) · [Testimonies](#) · 5 passages

Other Platonist Authors

- [Ἀλβῖνος ὁ Πλατωνικός](#) · [Albinus the Platonist](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀλέξανδρος Λυκοπολίτης](#) · [Alexander of Lycopolis](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀνώνυμος ὑπόμνημα εἰς τὸν Πλάτωνος Θεαίτητον](#) · [Anonymous Commentary on Plato](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀρίμνηστος](#) · [Arimnestus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀττικός](#) · [Atticus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Κάσσιος Λογγίνος](#) · [Cassius Longinus the Philosopher](#) · 3 works
- [Κέλσος ὁ Πλατωνικός](#) · [Celsus the Platonist](#) · 1 work
- [Κράντωρ ὁ Σολεύς](#) · [Crantor of Soli](#) · 2 works
- [Εὐδρόμος](#) · [Eudromus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός](#) · [Heraclides of Pontus](#) · 2 works
- [Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός](#) · [Heraclides of Pontus II](#) · 1 work

- Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus III · 1 work